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ATTACHMENT 5E

Lord Hill-Norton

The following is the Forward written by Lord Hill-Norton to Above Top Secret, a book published in 1987 by Timothy Good, a British UFO researcher. Lord Hill-Norton was Chief of Defence Staff, Ministry of Defense, in Great Britain (1971-73); and a Member of the House of Lords.

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**ABOVE
TOP SECRET**
The Worldwide UFO Cover-up

TIMOTHY GOOD

*With a foreword by Admiral of the Fleet
The Lord Hill-Norton GCB
Chief of Defence Staff 1971-73*



SIDGWICK & JACKSON
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FOREWORD

Tim Good has made a major contribution in this book to the UFO literature. He is one of the most thorough and best-informed researchers into this arcane subject and, as those who know him and his work would expect, he has based his book soundly upon fact and a great deal of most convincing evidence which I have not seen in print before.

It is fashionable, almost mandatory, for any serious attempt such as this to discuss UFOs to be rubbished by the media and dismissed by most of the public as science fiction at one extreme, or the work of a nut-case at the other. I do not think what follows could possibly be so easily ignored by any reader trained to weigh evidence - certainly I cannot do so.

I have frequently been asked why I am so keenly interested in UFOs; people seem to think it odd that someone who has been so closely involved with Defence for many years should be so simple. I am interested for several reasons. First, I have the sort of enquiring mind that likes to have things satisfactorily explained, and the one aspect of this whole matter which is starkly clear to me is that UFOs have *not* been explained, to my satisfaction. Indeed, so far as I am concerned the U stands more for *unexplained* than *unidentified*. Second, there is a very wide range of other unexplained phenomena which may or may not be related to UFOs but which have come to my notice in the UFO connection. Third, I am convinced that there is an official cover-up of the investigations which Governments have made into UFOs, certainly in the United States, probably in our own country, though not in France, and for all I know in Russia and other countries as far apart as Argentina, Spain, Australia and China to name just a few.

The evidence that there are objects which have been seen in our atmosphere, and even on terra firma, that cannot be accounted for either as man-made objects or as any physical force or effect known to our scientists seems to me to be overwhelming. I have read two or three

dozen respectable books, and many more less so; and I have listened to addresses by a dozen or more eminent speakers, in which a very large number of sightings have been vouched for by persons whose credentials seem to me unimpeachable. It is striking that so many have been trained observers, such as police officers and airline or military pilots. Their observations have in many instances – though by no means a majority – been supported either by technical means such as radar or, even more convincingly, by visible evidence of the condition of the observers or – and this is common to many events – interference with electrical apparatus of one sort or another. Tim Good gives chapter and verse for many telling examples of all these matters, and some disquieting evidence from witnesses of sightings, both in our own country and the USA, who claim to have been silenced by unidentified 'Government' officials. It is difficult to credit that they have all been either lying or hallucinating.

From the earliest days of the modern outbreak of sightings some forty years ago, there is a quite remarkable similarity between the descriptions given by observers of the flying vehicles. It is the more remarkable that there have been tens of thousands of these reports, from observers who range from illiterate peasants in Argentina and Spain to people with PhDs in other countries and they have all been given spontaneously – which has led to the generic term 'flying saucer'. It must be more than a coincidence.

As for what I have called bizarre phenomena, I need only refer to the astounding geometrical effects in the Alti Plano in South America of what seem like gigantic airfields laid out in the days of pre-history by means which would tax today's technology to the limit. And to the pyramid effects, and to the so-called navigational beacons, which could only be of use to a craft approaching earth from outside the atmosphere. These are physical phenomena which exist, and can be touched and measured; and no one knows how they were made, nor by whom, nor for what purpose.

Let me turn to some views on what I and many others believe to be the cover-up. There is no dispute that there have been at least two major investigations into UFOs in the United States in the last forty years, and there has been an acknowledged French Government investigation since 1954, but there has been no public acknowledgement of anything similar in Britain or elsewhere. Nothing of substance has ever been disclosed about the US investigations, and though in France the Government does seem to be more ready to take the public into its confidence, quite the reverse is true in both the United States and Russia, as many other official pronouncements have emphasized. While I cannot prove that there is a cover-up, I believe that Tim Good's book does so, certainly to my satisfaction. He shows beyond doubt that under the recent Free-

dom of Information Act in the files on the subject which have fairly recently been released against the Government, is that

There seem to me to be cover-up in the first rank, the possibility is that the UFOs are powers, and that their evidence of secrecy which makes Top simply do not believe this. If time as Chief of the Defence: the secret, but I was not, and words. Moreover, the enormity from sightings, and even optics enough to me that the technology these devices is far in advance mind our manned space flight in actual use anywhere on earth or, perhaps more likely, in its hypothesis is that I see no power man-made, the super-powers street could hardly be more weapons.

Second, it has been put about to capture a UFO, to learn its the results of their investigation and muddle up their plans. That that one or more powers asserts plainly in Chapter 16 fear that public interest will not have got their answers. Certain were true, and the results of made public, it might just be possible to discover more than was to reject out of hand either of the the first possibility, I think I should say so) but more practically be would not have got out. Practically rather than a conceptual nature Governments hate to admit it

The two further possibilities by Governments of public re-

dom of Information Act in the USA, there are secret, even top secret, files on the subject which have not been released, and that what has fairly recently been released there, as the result of a court decision against the Government, is telling enough.

There seem to me to be at least five possible explanations for a cover-up in the first rank, though there may well be others. The first possibility is that the UFOs are man-made, by one or both of the super powers, and that their evident potential as weapons demands a degree of secrecy which makes Top Secret look like *Beano*. I must say that I simply do not believe this. If it were so, then I am sure that during my time as Chief of the Defence Staff I could not have failed to be let in on the secret, but I was not, and if I had been I should not be writing these words. Moreover, the enormous and very consistent weight of evidence from sightings, and even optical and radar measurements, make it clear enough to me that the technology of construction and propulsion of these devices is far in advance of even that of our space probes, never mind our manned space flights. I am certain that were such technology in actual use anywhere on earth it would have surfaced, either in war or, perhaps more likely, in industry. My final reason for rejecting this hypothesis is that I see no possible reason why, should these devices be man-made, the super-powers should not just say so. The man in the street could hardly be more frightened than he is already of nuclear weapons.

Second, it has been put about that all the major powers are seeking to capture a UFO, to learn its secrets, and that if they admit or disclose the results of their investigations the general public will get into the act and muddle up their plans. Third, is a variant of that notion which holds that one or more powers actually have captured a UFO (Tim Good asserts plainly in Chapter 16 that this has been done in the USA) and fear that public interest will force them to disclose the fact before they have got their answers. Certainly if either of these unlikely explanations were true, and the results of the undoubted investigations were to be made public, it might just be possible for informed students of the subject to discover more than was thought to be good for them. For my part I reject out of hand either of these explanations, partly because, as with the first possibility, I think I should have known (and not be allowed to say so) but more practically because I just cannot believe that the secret would not have got out. Practically every other secret, of a physical rather than a conceptual nature, is already widely known - though Governments hate to admit it.

The two further possibilities on my list are both based on fear: fear by Governments of public reaction. The first possibility is that official

investigations have disclosed or revealed quite a lot about UFOs, even including their origin, method of construction and propulsion, and just possibly their purpose. If this is so, and if the enormous literature is to be believed, plainly there exists no human defence against them, should they be hostile. It is suggested that Governments believe this would cause such public 'alarm and despondency' (as we used to say in the Second World War) as to have even farther reaching social and political effects than the current opposition to nuclear weapons. This, I must concede, is just possible, though I do not myself believe it. On the contrary I think that were it true, the public would be relatively unmoved. Either they would not believe it or, through apathy or fatalism, they would instead shrug their shoulders and get on with what in 1987 is the difficult business of just living, winning the pools, planning holidays or going on strike - or all four.

The second of these last two possibilities is that investigations have disclosed that UFOs are not physical phenomena but paranormal, and they defy explanation. The reason for not disclosing these findings could then be reluctance to admit publicly that something very odd is going on, and that Governments do not know what it is. If so, the same line of argument about public fear applies, and I would use the same counter-arguments as before.

However these five possibilities may strike you, what seems to be common ground is that there have been thousands, perhaps tens of thousands, of sightings and encounters, physical results and of the latter, by people all over the world whose evidence on any other subject would be accepted without question. There have been major investigations lasting thirty or forty years by the Governments of the USA, Russia and France, for certain, and probably Britain and other countries. At the end of it all - today - we have no hard official information to weigh against some hundreds of books on the subject by private individuals or groups of individuals. I claim that the charge that there is a cover-up is thereby proved. What I admit defeats me is a plausible reason for it.

This excellent book adds a great deal of evidence to the whole dossier, and I warmly commend it to all who are interested in what, to me at any rate, remains a fascinating enigma.

HILL-NORTON